If at any point s is the empty string, then we have traversed the whole path in the trie corresponding to s: we then need to check current node to verify if our string s is stored in the tree or not.

If, instead, at some point current node doesn't have an outgoing edge matching current character c, then we are sure string s is not stored in the trie.

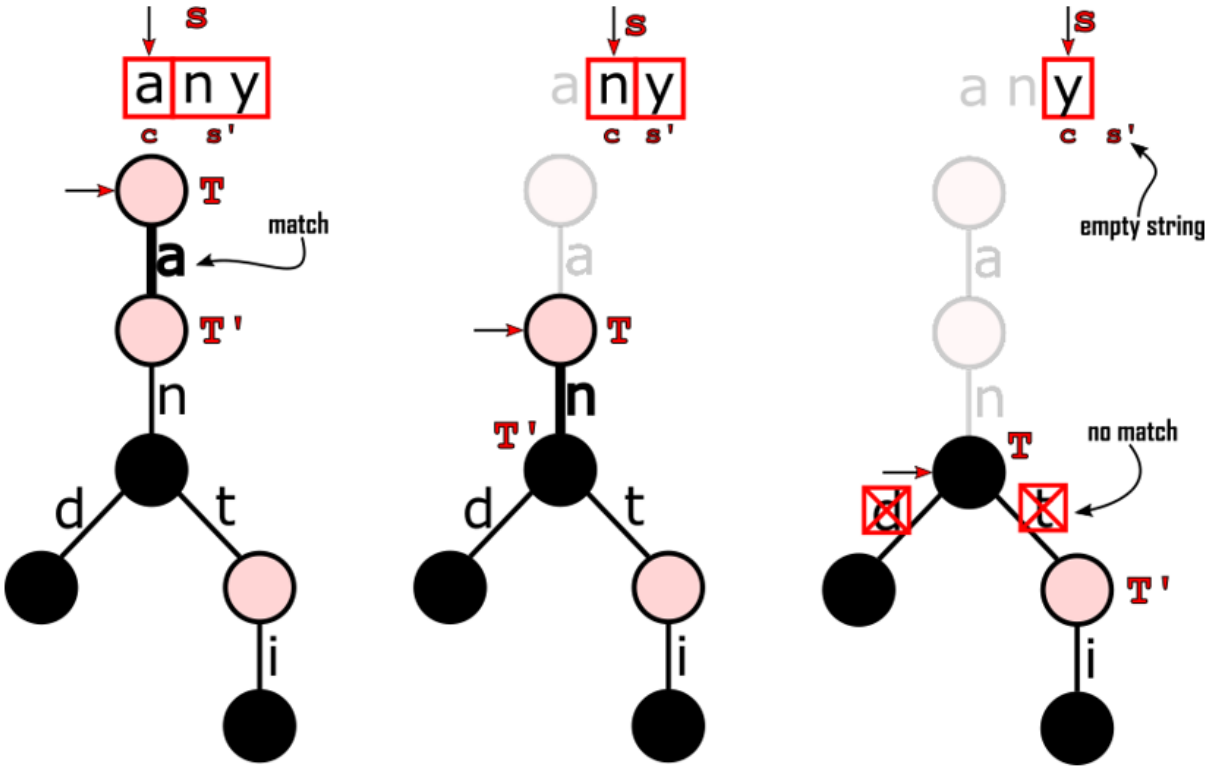


Figure 6.6 An unsuccessful search in a trie. At each step, we break the key to search, the string s, into c+s': the concatenation of its first character and the rest of the string; then we compare c to current node's outgoing edges, and if we find a match, we go ahead traversing the tree. In this example, the search fails because the last character in the string doesn't match any outgoing edge.